D07 · Order Management System (OMS/ATP/CTP)

04 · B2B order management: EDI, vendor portals & contract compliance

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1 WHAT IT IS

B2B order management handles contract-based orders exchanged electronically — EDI purchase orders, acknowledgments, advance ship notices and invoices — and the customer-specific requirements and service-level agreements attached to them.

2 WHY IT MATTERS

Large B2B customers, especially retailers, run their receiving on electronic documents and penalize non-compliance with OTIF, labeling or ASN requirements according to their supplier manuals. **Manual order entry introduces errors and delays that become chargebacks.** A well-mapped EDI flow lets customer service manage exceptions instead of typing orders.

3 HOW IT IS DONE

1. **Map each customer's documents and rules.** EDI 850/855/856/810 (or EDIFACT equivalents), labeling and delivery-window requirements.
2. **Automate end to end.** Receipt, validation, OMS, WMS and ASN without manual re-entry.
3. **Alert on SLA risk.** Flag orders that will miss the window while there is still time to act.
4. **Track chargebacks by cause.** Treat every penalty as a root-cause signal, not a cost of doing business.

IN PRACTICE

Well-configured EDI eliminates manual work in B2B order processing

A fully automated EDI flow (receipt -> mapping -> OMS -> WMS without manual intervention) frees the CS team to manage exceptions and relationships, not to process orders.

Configure OTIF risk alerts in the OMS for penalty customers

An order that has been in the WMS for 36 hours without having started picking for a customer with a 48-hour delivery window is an OTIF risk that can be managed if detected in time.

The 856 (ASN) sent to the retailer before dispatch is as important as the dispatch itself

Major retailers confirm ASN receipt before scheduling the dock appointment. An ASN sent late or with incorrect data can result in a rejection at the retailer's door — which counts as an OTIF non-compliance.

Integrate B2B customer SLA compliance into the S&OP process

OTIF of key B2B customers must be part of the S&OP dashboard — with visibility of at-risk penalties and root causes of non-compliances to take systemic corrective actions.

ILLUSTRATIVE CASE

Illustrative case built from typical industry values — not data from a specific company.

Illustrative case: EDI order management — FMCG supplier, 3 B2B retailers with strict OTIF SLA — Supplier receives 180 EDI orders/week from 3 retailers with OTIF SLAs of 96%, 98%, and 99%.

EDI process element	Status before optimization	Improvement implemented
EDI order processing time (receipt to OMS to WMS)	HIGH	4.2 hours average via overnight batch · Urgent orders arrived “the next day”

EDI process element	Status before optimization	Improvement implemented
EDI mapping errors (orders rejected for incorrect format)	MEDIUM	2.8% of orders rejected and requiring manual reprocessing
OTIF risk alerts (orders at risk of arriving late)	HIGH	0% proactive alerts · CS discovered risk only when customer reported the non-compliance
856 management (ASN: dispatch notice to retailer)	MEDIUM	ASN sent with 1.4 hours average delay vs. retailer SLA

Result: OTIF improved from 91.2% to 96.8% in 6 months. Biggest impact: proactive OTIF risk alerts — 68% of at-risk orders were managed before becoming a non-compliance. OTIF penalties: -$280K/year.

HOW IT IS MEASURED

EDI Order Processing Accuracy % (EDI orders processed without mapping error)

EDI Order Processing Accuracy %(EDI orders processed automatically without error or rejection / Total EDI orders received) × 100

Benchmark: >99% accuracy in EDI order processing with well-configured mappings EDI accuracy <97% indicates mapping problems that generate manual work for the CS team — and delays in processing that impact order OTIF.

OTIF Penalty Amount ($) — penalties for B2B customer SLA non-compliance

OTIF Penalty Amount ($)Total penalties billed by B2B customers for OTIF non-compliance in the period

Benchmark: $0 as objective · Any paid penalty indicates OTIF <100% for the corresponding customer Penalty amount is the most direct financial metric of B2B OTIF non-compliance impact. A growing penalty amount requires an urgent root cause analysis.

WHAT YOU WOULD USE

EDI & B2B OMS

SAP SD + SAP Integration Suite — EDI Integration — Module: EDI Processing + B2B Order ManagementSAP S/4HANA with EDI capabilities for B2B order processing. Manages EDI mappings, automatic order processing, and ASN sending to the retailer.

TrueCommerce / SPS Commerce — Module: EDI Network + Compliance ManagementEDI platforms that connect the supplier with the retailer network. Manage EDI mappings by retailer, ASN generation, and SLA compliance tracking.

4 SO WHAT

Automate the B2B order flow and manage to the customer's rules. Map EDI per customer, remove manual entry, alert on SLA risk and turn every chargeback into a fix.

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